

Respectful Competitor-in-Place Opener

Script - Skill: objections - Difficulty: advanced - Est. 8 min

Draft resource pending human editorial review - not yet professionally verified.

An approach for prospects who already use a competitor - it respects their current choice, asks what is and is not working, and offers a specific difference instead of trash-talking the incumbent.

Learning objectives

- Respect the prospect's existing decision
- Learn what works and what they would change
- Offer one concrete, honest point of difference
- Never disparage the competitor

Approach in four beats

1. Acknowledge they already have a solution - no surprise, no judgment.
2. Ask what is working well before anything else.
3. Ask the one thing they would change if they could.
4. Only if there is a real gap, offer one specific difference you can stand behind.

Talk about them, not the competitor

- Never call the incumbent bad - it insults their choice and your credibility.
- Anchor on the change they named, not on a feature war.
- If they are genuinely happy, thank them and leave the door open.

Worked example

"You are already using Meridian - good tool, I am not here to knock it. Out of curiosity, what is working well with it for you? ... And if you could change one thing about it, what would it be? ... The reporting delay you mentioned is actually the one area we are built differently, so that might be worth a look. If everything is fine as-is, though, I will not try to talk you out of a setup that works."

Safe-practice note

Never disparage a competitor or imply the prospect made a poor choice - it damages trust and often backfires. Only claim a difference you can genuinely deliver and demonstrate. If the prospect is satisfied with what they have, respect that and leave without pressure.

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